LANGUAGE TYPOLOGY AND UNIVERSALS
QUIZ
[SPRING 2025-26]

Max. Time: 45 minutes **Max. Marks: 35**

Answer all the questions:

Q1. Observe the Language Change: [8+2 = 10 marks]

Our Father, Who is in heaven,
Holy is Your Name;
Your kingdom come,
Your will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread,
and forgive us our sins,
as we forgive those who sin against us;
and lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil. Amen.

This is the newer version of a text given for your reference. Given below are the two versions of the same text in Middle English and Early Modern English. Compare Middle English with Early Modern English and point out the different kinds of language changes found with respect to morphology, syntax, semantics and lexical items. Comment on what is retained in Modern English.

Middle English:

Oure fadir þat art in heuenes halwid be þi name;
þi reume or kyngdom come to be. Be þi wille don in herþe as it is doun in heuene.
yeue to us today oure eche dayes bred.
And foryeue to us oure dettis þat is oure synnys as we foryeuen to oure dettouris þat is to men þat han synned in us.
And lede us not into temptacion but delyuere us from euyl.

Early Modern English:

Our father which art in heauen, hallowed be thy name.
Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth as it is in heauen.
Giue us this day our daily bread.
And forgiue us our debts as we forgiue our debters.
And lead us not into temptation, but deliuer us from euill. Amen.

Q2. Write short notes on <u>any two</u>: [6 x 2 = 12 marks]

a. Grimm's law and Great Vowel Shift

b. Human language vs other communication systems

c. Merger and Split phonemic changes

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Q3. Give two examples for each of the following types of sound changes. Explain the sound change in one sentence. [2x4 = 8 marks]

a. Syncope
b. Prothesis
c. Metathesis
d. Haplology

Q4. Share how your language has changed over the years with age and experiences. Give examples wherever needed. [5 marks]